

Cognitive Process Profile (CPP)

Standard Report for Skillcapital LLP

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL

NAME:

James Parsons

CPP NUMBER:

CPP342350 (Z684243)

ASSESSMENT DATE:

2019-06-14



Introduction

The CPP

The Cognitive Process Profile (CPP) is a computerised exercise that has been designed to externalise and dynamically track a person's cognitive processes to give an indication of thinking preferences, capabilities and potential for growth. The thinking processes are interpreted using algorithms. The aim of the CPP report is to provide an understanding of a person's thinking skills and learning potential to inform decisions regarding selection, placement, team compilation, succession and development. The results are described narratively and graphically.

Please note that the scores in **this CPP report** reflects the use of the latest **2016 Norm Group** based on the results of a highly diverse, international sample. Do not compare CPP results based on different norm groups.

Cognitive constructs reported on by the CPP

- The theoretical model on which the CPP is based
- Suitable SST work environment
 - Current and potential work environments
 - Work-related processing dimensions
 - Unit of information
- Stylistic preferences and capabilities
- Task requirements associated with processing tendencies
- Speed and pace control
- Processing competencies
 - Strengths and development areas
- Learning potential
- Developmental guidelines
- Summary of results
- Graphic summary

Biographical information

Full name:	James Parsons
Gender:	Male
Date assessed:	2019-06-14
Report date:	2019-06-14
Unique test number:	CPP342350 (Z684243)
Date of birth:	1975-06-07
Nationality:	United Kingdom
Ethnicity:	Caucasian / White European
Highest education:	Other
Discipline:	Other
Functional area:	Other
Current position:	Other
Colour blind:	No
Previous CPP:	No

Self-evaluation

This section was filled out by the candidate after completing the CPP.

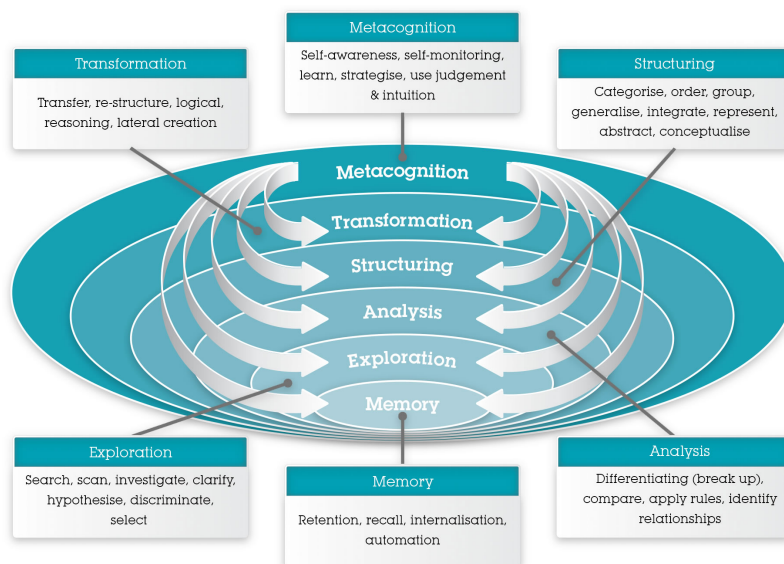
How well did you understand the test?	Quite well
How difficult did you find it?	Fairly hard
How well do you think you did?	Quite well
Were you anxious or afraid?	Quite anxious
How well could you concentrate?	Fairly well
How much did you enjoy the test?	A bit

The theoretical model on which the CPP is based

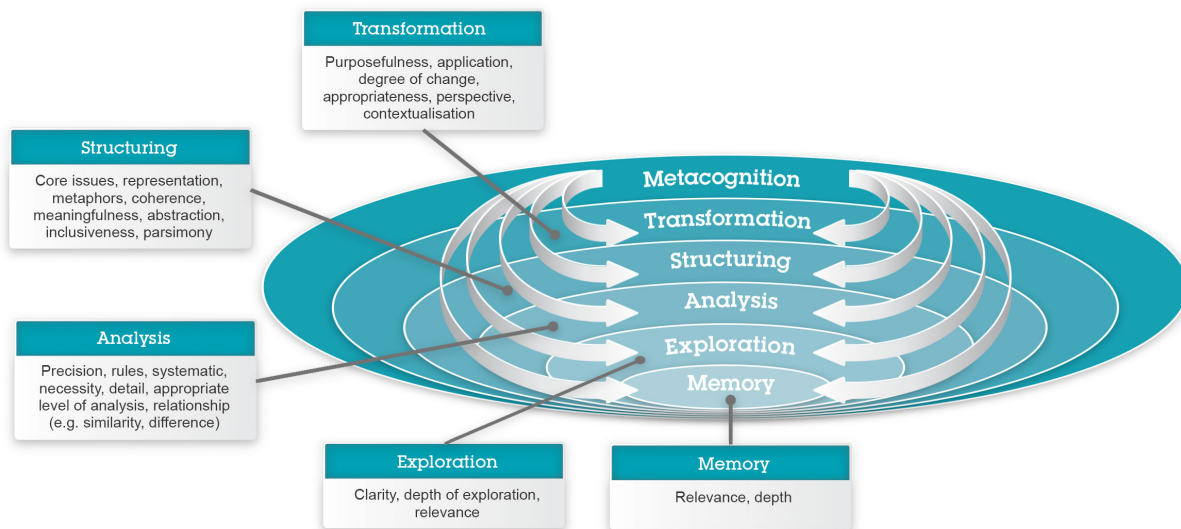
The holonic structure of the functional processing categories

The CPP externalises and tracks information processing activities and represents these in terms of functional categories organised as holons, where each successive process includes and transcends the previous one(s). Alternatively, the processing categories can be represented as overlapping fields of a matrix, the axes of which represent: (a) the increasing complexity of the information involved; and (b) the increasingly inclusive sequence of cognitive processes applied (as described in the CPP research manual).

The theoretical model of cognitive processes on which the CPP is based, differentiates between 'performance' and 'metacognitive' processes. Performance processes are applied to task material to recall, explore, analyse, structure, and transform information. The application of the performance processes is guided by specific metacognitive criteria. Cognitive development requires the internalisation and automatisisation of metacognitive criteria.



The metacognitive criteria which guide the application of cognitive processes



Suitable SST work environment

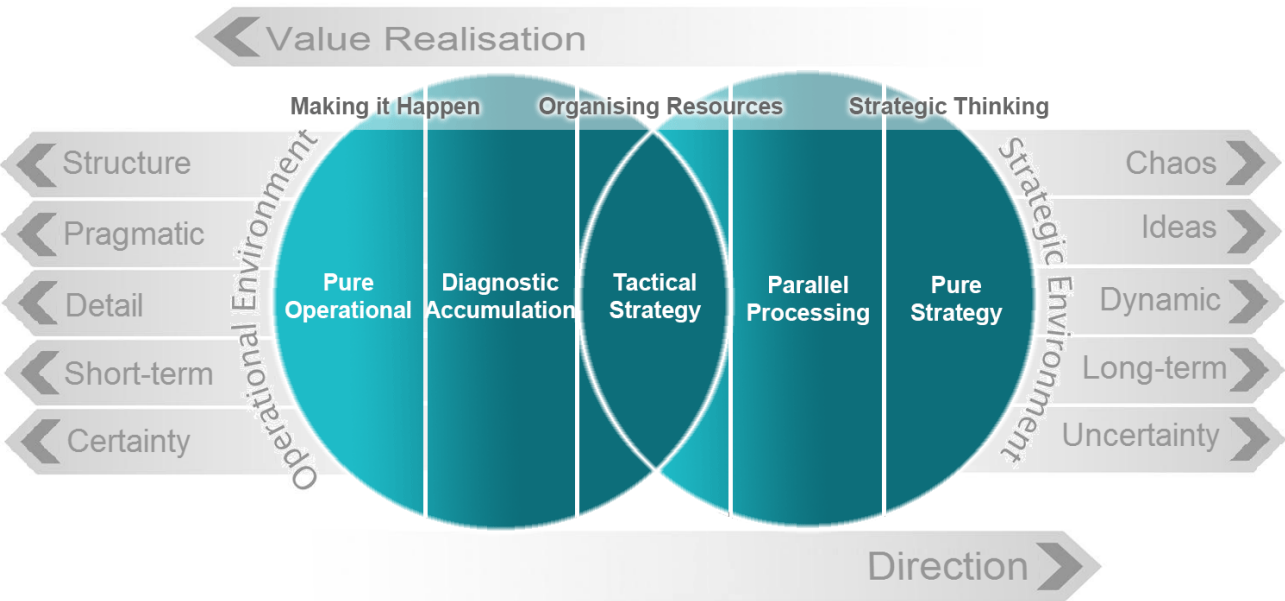
The CPP links a person's cognitive profile to the cognitive requirements of specific operational and strategic work environments.

Algorithms are used to compare the qualitative and quantitative characteristics of a person's profile to the requirements of five work environments. The profile qualities considered include a person's: (a) stylistic preferences, (b) the units of information used in processing, (c) judgement and decision making tendencies, as well as (d) eight job-related processing dimensions.

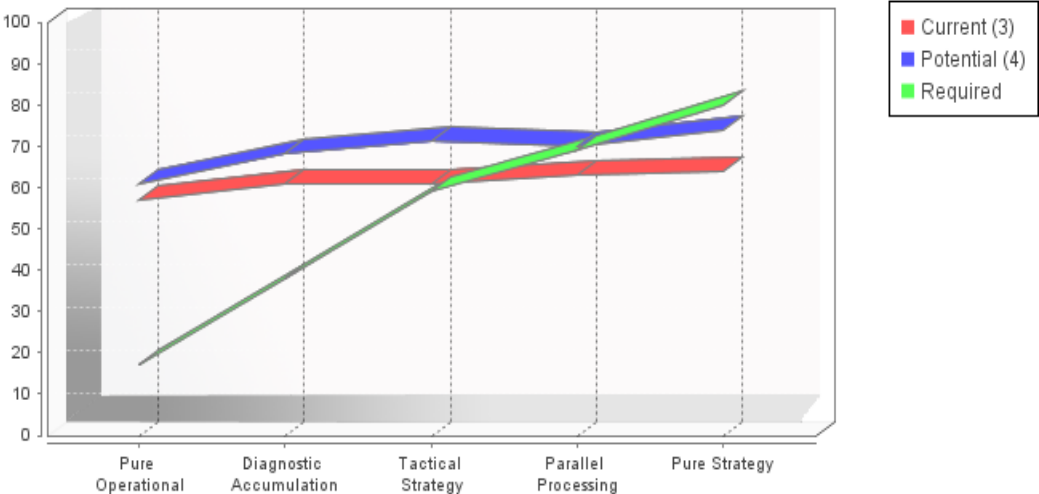
The work environments specified reflect the Stratified Systems Model (SST) of E Jaques, the Viable Systems Model (VSM) of S Beer and M Prinsloo's work on cognitive complexity.

Both 'current' and 'potential' work environments are indicated but no time frames are given to predict the person's readiness to progress from the current to the potential environment as this depends on many different factors including opportunity and motivation.

Operational and strategic work environments



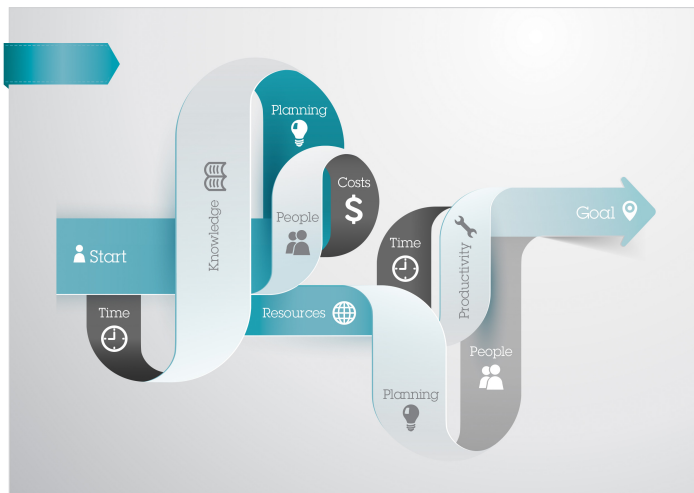
James's progress through the assessment was tracked and this is shown graphically below. This gives an indication of his preferred current and potential working environment.



James's current work environment

James's cognitive profile currently seems best suited to the following work environment:

Tactical strategy



- Optimising systems efficiencies
- Formulate functional strategy
- Benchmarking
- Goal achievement of a functional unit
- Create alternative strategic paths
- Evaluate and implement systems
- Planning and resource allocation
- Follow theoretical guidelines
- Project management
- Professional work

A Tactical Strategy work environment can be described as follows:

Type of work

- Works with a whole operating system or functional unit

Ways of working

- Optimises the goal achievement of the functional unit using various tactics
- Uses specialised knowledge of operational work and incorporates theory and experience
- Finds best practice solutions to problems
- Makes the best use of all available resources (human, material and financial)
- Evaluates systems and practices and implements new systems
- Professional practice

Information used

- Complex, concrete and abstract
- Meaningful wholes, systems, plans, budgets and networks
- Ambiguous goals and outcomes
- Relatively stable contexts

Outputs / achievements

- Ambiguous and are judged in terms of operating efficiencies
- Cannot be predicted linearly but must be extrapolated from the principles of systems functioning

Judgement

- Relates to planning and implementation to optimise resources

Language used

- Focuses on the symbolic (consumables, equipment and resources)

Learning

- Hypothesising, implementation and continuous evaluation of theoretical and practical knowledge

Time frame

- Ranges from one year to three years for the most complex tasks

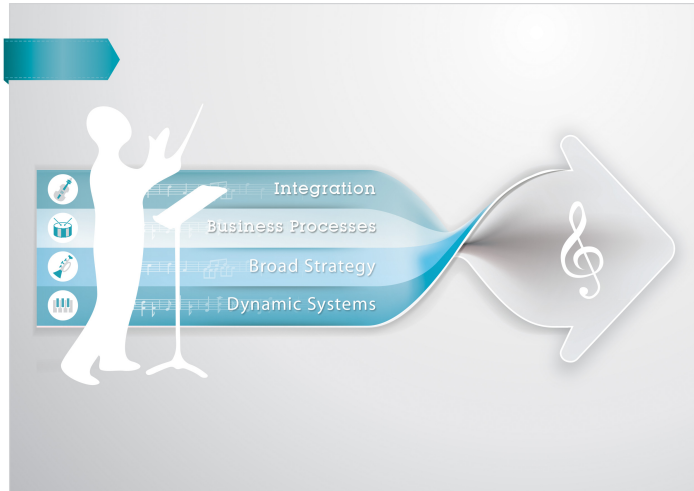
Examples

- First level of organisational improvement
- Management of operating systems (divisional, middle, senior or general manager)
- Professionals and specialists operating independently

Potential work environment

James shows the potential to develop the necessary cognitive competencies to effectively function in the following work environment:

Parallel Processing



- Integrate dynamic systems (value chains, supply-demand factors)
- Synchronise parallel pathways
- Use trade-offs to maintain progress
- Coordinate functional units
- Formulate business processes and broad business strategy
- Ensure organisational viability
- Systems focused
- Maintain the pace of and monitor interacting projects

A Parallel Processing work environment can be described as follows:

Type of work

- Focuses on business processes and business strategy
- Involves co-ordinating the work of various functional or business units
- Ensures that the organisation remains viable

Ways of working

- Plans and implements long-term business solutions
- Translates abstract ideas and decisions into strategies and tactics
- Plans how the organisation is to be managed to achieve its mission statement
- Manages and co-ordinates several interacting projects, or programmes simultaneously in order to achieve an overall objective
- Manoeuvres resources between interacting projects to capitalise on economies of scale
- Builds models
- Has true accountability

Information used

- Primarily complex, unfamiliar and ambiguous
- Often abstract, theoretical and generalised, such as long-term policies, broad strategies, values, business processes and solutions
- Ambiguous realities and goals
- Unstable and unpredictable contexts

Outputs / achievements

- Often abstract and theoretical
- Organisational change and transformation
- Development of new functionalities and models

Judgement

- Profit and loss accountability, directing the implementation of strategies to ensure organisational viability

Language used

- A conceptual focus (talent pool, culture, values, capital accumulation, assets, labour)

Learning

- Hypothesising and testing abstract conceptual models and strategies

Time frame

- Ranges from three years to five years for the most complex task

Examples

- General management, executive and CEO levels
- Chief specialist roles in the organisation
- Developers of new functionalities

Work-related processing dimensions

The work-related processing preferences are used in conjunction with cognitive style, unit of information and judgement capability, to determine a most suitable work environment for a person.

Personal preferences for Operational or Strategic work can be described in terms of four dimensions:

- Complexity
- Tangibility / type of the information
- Time frames
- Degree of structure of the work environment

The person's preferences and capabilities can guide job placement decisions and indicate the most appropriate developmental initiatives.

Notes: (see the table on the following page) Interpreting the work-related processing scores:

Strategic orientation (right column): These scores reflect skill in dealing with the processing requirements of Strategic environments. Scores of up to approximately 40 support Operational functioning; roughly 40 - 60 enable Diagnostic Accumulation functioning; 60 - 70 point to Tactical Strategy functioning, around 70 - 77 suggest Parallel Processing functioning and scores exceeding approximately 77 indicate Pure Strategic functioning.

Operational orientation (left column): These mostly (excluding 'Detail') reveal a complementary score to that of the opposite pole on the right of a particular dimension. The scores in the left column are thus interpreted relative to the person's scores in the right column. 'Relatively high' scores are above 50.

- Relatively high scores on 'Detail complexity' indicate skill in dealing with technical detail, but not necessarily a preference for detail. Relatively low scores on 'Detail complexity' may indicate an avoidance of detail even though the person may have the capacity to deal with it.
- Relatively high scores on 'Tangible' indicates a pragmatic and hands-on approach and preference for well-defined contexts. Both high 'Tangible' and high 'Intangible' scores (thus an overlap between the two poles) is possible and this indicates adaptability to both types of environments.
- A relatively high score on 'Short-term' may indicate a reliance on immediate feedback given, the tendency to view issues simplistically, to jump to conclusions and to make assumptions.
- A relatively high score on 'Structured' indicates a need for ordered contexts and shows either the capacity to structure environments independently or to require structured environments.

James's results indicate the following work related processing preferences and capabilities:

Operational orientation	Strategic orientation
64	68
Detail complexity The application of a detailed, specialist and technical approach – where the focus is on facts, rules, linear sequences and relationships. (High IQ may elevate this score – but not necessarily, and an irritation with detailed technical work may lower it.)	Dynamic complexity The application of an integrative approach – where the focus is on underlying patterns and the interactions between elements and systems (non-sequential patterns, circularity, feedback systems). (Inadequate capability, learning opportunity and exposure may lower this score.)
49	68
Tangible information The application of a hands-on approach – where the focus is on tangible, concrete, well-structured and practical issues.	Intangible information The application of an ideas-oriented approach – where the focus is on new concepts, ideas, creativity, learning, quick insight, flexibility, intuition and an interest in ideas and possibilities. (An avoidance of new, abstract and / or hypothetical concepts may lower this score.)
43	61
Short-term focus The application of a trial-and-error approach – characterised by a preference for feedback and guidelines where the focus is on concrete actions and immediate effects within a familiar environment. A relatively high score may also reflect imprecision, assumptions, quick closure, impulsivity and inadequate planning.	Long-term focus The application of a disciplined and consequential reasoning approach – where the focus is on logical thinking, the following through of arguments and the evaluation of the effects of evolving situations. (A low level of motivation and interest may lower this score.)
41	71
Structured contexts A preference for order and structure (external or self-created) – where the focus is on guidelines, rules, linear procedures as well as capitalising on knowledge and experience. (It reflects both the search for existing structures and creation of structures.)	Unstructured contexts The preference for an unfamiliar environment – where judgement and intuition are applied confidently and effectively in clarifying vague, unstructured and ambiguous information. (Low confidence in own intuitive insights may lower this score.)

Complexity and unit of information

Individuals tend to focus on specific levels of complexity when dealing with information and when solving problems.

Five units of information can be identified to indicate the level of complexity involved, namely:

- (a) separate elements
- (b) relationships and linear causality
- (c) tangible systems
- (d) dynamic and interactive systems
- (e) chaos and emerging patterns

These five units of information are linearly related to the five work environments. If the level of complexity required in a work environment matches the person's cognitive preference and capability to deal with that level of complexity, the person may experience a sense of being 'in flow'. If a person's approach and the job requirements are mismatched, it may result in boredom or stress and impact on job satisfaction and motivation.

James tends to utilise the following units of information:

Unit of information	Description
Tangible systems 	Optimising system efficiencies - planning and structuring - generating alternatives - co-ordination of structural elements within a system - interactions between tangible elements
Dynamic and interactive systems 	Conceptualising change and integration - co-ordination across systems and contexts - a process approach - dealing with vagueness and intangibles - constructing theoretical models

Cognitive styles

Cognitive styles refer to broad response tendencies or patterns in thinking and problem-solving behaviour. These are measured by tracking a person's responses to unfamiliar information. A person's stylistic preferences when dealing with unfamiliar information, however, also tend to be used when working with familiar information. Some personality factors are indicated here, as these are sometimes evident in the way a person thinks.

A person may develop specific stylistic preferences due to personality and emotional factors, cultural values, educational exposure, learning opportunities, work experience and fields of interest. In interpreting this report, the specific combination of preferred styles provides a useful indication of certain factors in the person's developmental history.

Various descriptive categories are reported on as indications of stylistic preference, namely: Explorative, Analytical, Logical, Structured, Reflective, Reactive, Trial-and-error, Integrative, Holistic, Intuitive, Quick Insight, Learning, Metaphoric and Memory approaches. A Trial-and-error or Reactive style may be an indication of performance anxiety, emotional or developmental factors. It may also be a valid reflection of the person's approach to unfamiliar problem-solving. Insight can be gained from interpreting the person's particular combination of stylistic preferences. The construct "Style" also informs the identification of a suitable work environment.

James tends to apply the following styles in unfamiliar contexts and is highly likely to also apply these styles in familiar contexts:

EXPLORATIVE



Explorative style:

- Tends to investigate issues
- Thoroughly explores different types of information
- Checks information carefully and precisely
- Tries to understand the task requirements
- Focuses on finding information relevant to the problem
- May get confused by over-exploring and checking too much
- May repeatedly explore the same information without moving forward

QUICK INSIGHT



Quick Insight style:

- Tends to work quickly and accurately
- Grasps ideas and reaches conclusions relatively quickly
- Tends to focus and process information in a goal-oriented manner
- Processes and integrates information relatively quickly
- Uses effective reasoning and memory strategies
- Is likely to be self-confident and takes pride in working quickly
- May be sensitive, intuitive and trusts own insights
- Considers the speed at which information is processed as important

LEARNING



Learning style:

- Tends to be curious and explorative
- Often capitalises on memory functions
- Is self-aware and takes account of any feedback that is given
- Tends to continuously improve problem-solving skills
- Is adaptable, flexible and able to acquire new ways of thinking
- Seeks novelty and focuses on unfamiliar aspects
- Usually is motivated, concentrates well and invests in problem-solving
- Can easily get bored, so needs challenge and stimulation
- Is likely to enjoy fast-changing work environments

INTUITIVE



Intuitive style:

- Usually explores and checks information in a seemingly aimless manner
- Often relies on previous knowledge and experience
- Largely relies on connections made at a subconscious level
- Interprets complex information at gut level
- Trusts own feelings and instincts
- Likely to be self-aware, sensitive, open-minded and perceptive
- May integrate information to formulate creative and unusual ideas
- Does not necessarily rely on an analytical approach

The order that James applied all the styles is:

- | | | |
|------------------|----------------|---------------------|
| 1. Explorative | 6. Reflective | 11. Memory |
| 2. Quick insight | 7. Holistic | 12. Reactive |
| 3. Learning | 8. Structured | 13. Trial-and-error |
| 4. Intuitive | 9. Logical | 14. Metaphoric |
| 5. Integrative | 10. Analytical | |

Rank order of cognitive styles

Metacognition refers to awareness of one's own thinking processes. Each of the cognitive styles is guided by certain internalised metacognitive criteria. This means that a person's thinking processes reflect specific rules that are applied automatically or via self-talk. For example: a person who values accuracy and has internalised it as a metacognitive criterion, is likely to apply an analytical approach to problem-solving. The following styles reflect the application of the specified metacognitive criteria. First the preferred styles will be discussed, then the styles that are applied the least (if any were underutilised). This will provide an indication of broad cognitive development areas.

James's most prominent stylistic preferences:

Rank	Preference	Description	Implications
1	Explorative	A tendency to investigate and gather information. Metacognitive criteria: “clarity”, “relevance”, “depth”	It may be associated with interest and curiosity, but may also indicate a need for certainty and understanding. Excessive information-gathering may complicate and postpone decision-making and action.
2	Quick insight	A tendency to grasp concepts relatively quickly. Metacognitive criterion: “meaning”	It may reflect cognitive capability; may be associated with intuition, learning and metacognitive awareness. It may reflect cultural values emphasising speed. It contributes to problem-solving effectiveness in general.
3	Learning	A tendency to pursue cognitive challenges, to acquire new skills and to improve own functioning. Metacognitive criteria: “error”, “correctness”, “improvement”	It is associated with curiosity, an adaptable and open-minded approach, concentration, metacognitive awareness and the integration of feedback to improve own responses.
4	Intuitive	A tendency to show openness, awareness and rely on “gut feel” insights. Metacognitive criteria: “gut feel”, “certainty”	Develops as a result of trust in own opinion and wisdom. Associated with sensitivity to subtle internal and external cues. Enhanced by a sense of being 'in flow'.
5	Integrative	A tendency to synthesise discrepant, fragmented and ambiguous information into a coherent / meaningful whole. Metacognitive criteria: “meaning”, “coherence”, “context”, “depth”, “parsimony”, “inclusiveness”	Required for conceptualisation, definition, formulation and model building. Can be developed by trying to understand and represent vague or problematic issues.

James seems **less inclined** to implement the following styles (this list starts from the least frequently applied style and excludes the Trial-and-error and Reactive styles if they are among the least frequently applied):

Rank	Preference	Description	Implications
14	Metaphoric	A tendency to compare and link a concept to a symbol, story or abstraction. Metacognitive criteria: “abstraction”, “meaning” “representation”, “picture”, “change”, “perspective”, “unusual”	In order to formulate unusual and creative ideas that capture the interest of others and enhance their understanding of certain issues, James could develop the habit of identifying metaphors, idioms or pictures that concisely reflect certain messages.

Task requirements and associated processing tendencies

Current and potential preference and skill in dealing with specific task requirements

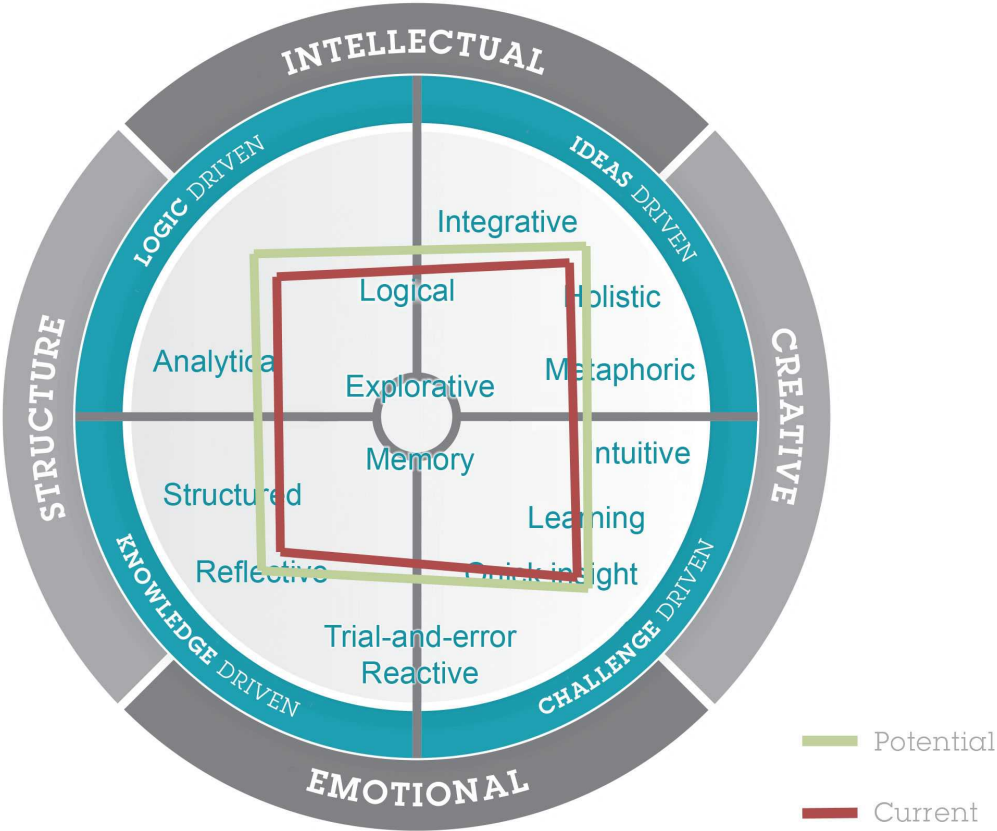
The various thinking styles above can also be represented in terms of the brain quadrants metaphor. The various quadrants indicate preferences for, and skill in, dealing with certain types of information and specific task requirements, including:

Logic	Ideas	Challenge	Structure
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The typical right quadrant preferences are associated with an ideas orientation and creative tendencies and the left quadrant preferences with a more structured, focused and factual orientation. The upper quadrants are more intellectually driven than the lower quadrants that are associated with emotional motives such as the need for certainty versus the need for challenge. The relative contribution of specific cognitive styles have been superimposed / positioned in blue on the graph.

James's preference and skill regarding the task requirements

The graph below indicates James's current preferences and potential for dealing with these various types of processing requirements.



Interpretation of the skills and preferences associated with particular task requirements

Structured, rule-based approaches: dealing with facts in a logical, analytical, sequential and organised manner:

- Logic driven: a preference for logical-analytical reasoning, using facts. It involves the application of rule-based, focused and relatively structured information processing. People who achieve relatively high scores in this quadrant typically enjoy intellectual challenge and information-rich, technical and professional contexts.
- Knowledge driven: a preference for the relatively well-structured information that is characteristic of domain-specific and operational work environments where one can capitalise on existing knowledge and experience. In terms of the complexity involved, it may range from dealing with tangible and concrete phenomena to more complex theoretical information. The emotional security offered by the familiarity of the task material generally enhances performance.

Holistic and Creative approaches: dealing with ideas and new challenges by making meaning of, and contextualising the information:

- Ideas-driven: a preference for integrating fragmented and / or theoretical information in a meaningful way. The generation of unique and innovative ideas are characteristic of this mode. People who achieve relatively high scores in this quadrant typically enjoy intellectual challenge and generally apply a contextualised or holistic approach.
- Challenge-driven: flexible, open-minded awareness, curiosity and a learning orientation. Relatively high scores in this quadrant are associated with the tendencies to become bored and to challenge oneself and others. This may be driven by an emotional need for novelty and variety. Those showing this preference perform best when having to deal with interesting and meaningful information.

Speed and pace control

Speed and Power are two separate constructs in cognition. The CPP allows the person to work at his/her own pace. Four speed-related dimensions are reported on, namely: pace of problem-solving; how quickly new information is grasped; the time spent on easy versus difficult aspects; and the tendency to come to close problems quickly. Scores are normally distributed between 25 and 75.

James's speed and pace control scores:

Dimension	Description	Score
Speed of work	The speed or pace by which unfamiliar cognitive tasks are completed	76
Quick insight	The rate of grasping and understanding concepts	75
Pace control	The tendency to spend most time on the most difficult task requirements	83
Quick closure	The tendency to jump to conclusions and make assumptions	34

Notes: Interpreting Speed and Power

The various constructs reported on are independently measured. Thus seemingly contradictory results are possible – such as high scores on both ‘Pace control’ and ‘Quick closure’. This can be interpreted qualitatively.

If the ‘Speed of work’ score is relatively close to the ‘Quick insight’ score, then the person works at a reasonable pace, given their natural inclination and capability. If the ‘Speed of work’ score is higher than ‘Quick insight’, then the person worked at a faster rate than they understood the task requirements. If the ‘Quick insight’ score is higher than the ‘Speed of work’ score, then the person worked relatively slowly and carefully. ‘Pace control’ scores are important and indicate the person’s insight into the difficulty of the task and how they adjusted their pace to spend more time on more difficult aspects.

As a broad guideline, a score of 60 and above can generally be regarded as a high score on the constructs of ‘Speed of work’, ‘Quick insight’ and ‘Pace control’, and a score below 35 - 40 as a relatively low score. A relatively high score on ‘Quick closure’ may indicate that emotional and motivational factors interfered with the effectiveness of processing. It may also show low cognitive rigour or discipline. Relatively low scores are desirable on ‘Quick closure’. On this construct, scores above 50 can be regarded as relatively high.

Information processing competencies

This bar graph provides a graphic representation of the person's functioning on the six processing categories namely: Memory, Exploration, Analysis, Structuring and Integration, Transformation and Metacognition. All are Performance processes, except Metacognition which guides the application of the Performance Processes. These functional processing categories can be represented as a holon where each successive process includes and transcends the previous one(s). The dynamic functioning of the processes are explained by the theoretical processing model on which the CPP assessment is based.

This following simplified graphical representation summarises James's results and is useful to guide decision-making and cognitive development initiatives in work and educational contexts.

Processing competency		Description	Scores
Memory	Use of Memory	A tendency to rely on memory and to concentrate on the task	55
	Memory Strategies	Effectiveness of memory strategies	43
Exploration	Pragmatic	Practical orientation (asking whether things will work in practice). Determining relevance in structured contexts	76
	Exploration	The effectiveness, depth and width of exploration	72
Analysis	Analysis	Working systematically, independently. Detailed and precise in differentiating between, and linking, elements	45
	Rules	A focus on rules	42
Structuring / Integration	Categorisation	Creating external order, categories and reminders. Structuring tangibles	66
	Integration	Synthesis of ambiguous / discrepant / fragmented information	64
	Complexity	The preferred level of complexity and the unit of information used	64
Transformation	Logical Reasoning	The disciplined, logical following through of reasoning processes	49
	Verbal Conceptualisation	Unusual / flowery / creative and / or abstract verbalisation and conceptualisation	39
Metacognition	Judgement	Capitalising on intuitive insights to clarify unstructured and vague information	71
	Quick Insight Learning	A tendency to grasp new concepts and acquire knowledge and understanding relatively quickly	69
	Gradual Improvement Learning	A preference for practical or experiential learning	63

Cognitive strengths and development areas

The following table reveals those processing dimensions that the person scored significantly higher or lower on as compared to his average processing scores on the left, as well as his current work environment. This is a very detailed part of the report and is provided to inform cognitive development initiatives. This section should be managed holistically – and not by focusing on the complex detail.

James's processing strengths and development areas:

Table of Cognitive Strengths and Development Areas	STRENGTHS		DEVELOPMENT AREAS	
	Own profile	Current work environment	Own profile	Current work environment
Exploration				
Discrimination: Deciding what is important in a relatively structured, familiar environment	2	1		
Exploration: Depth of investigation of a problem or situation		1		
Self-directed focusing and selecting: Investigating a problem according to a plan and goal	2			
Analytical				
Checking: Repeatedly revisiting detailed issues - often to "make sure"				1
Structuring and Integration				
Abstract conceptualisation: Expressing conceptual thinking by using creative, abstract language			3	1
Task orientation and goal direction: A focus on the task's purpose, requirements and desired outcome.	1			
Transformation				
Following arguments through: A tendency to apply a process-approach and pursue the line of reasoning in a disciplined manner until the underlying complexity converges			1	
Metacognition				
Memory strategies: The use of techniques and aids to assist memory functioning. (Checking to ensure accuracy may lower this score)			1	1
Metacognition: Self-awareness regarding problem-solving approach	2			
Task orientation and goal direction: A focus on the task's purpose, requirements and desired outcomes	1			
Learning: Improving understanding by adjusting, expanding and integrating information structures in a self-aware manner	1			
Clarification: Interpreting, judging, weighting and prioritising unclear information	2			

Note: the strength of the finding is indicated numerically in the table above. Higher numbers indicate a more significant finding. Treat scores two and above as significant.

Learning potential

It is difficult to predict a person’s future and potential cognitive functioning on the basis of current performance, given the long term impact of variables such as emotionality, motivation, educational and work exposure. Cognitive performance is evaluated in depth to identify indicators of cognitive modifiability. The slopes of learning curves and the effectiveness of information processes are interpreted. This gives an indication of the person’s potential to increase current cognitive functioning as well as the capacity to master new knowledge or content areas. This information can inform decisions regarding the utilisation and development of talent.

James shows an average to above average level of learning potential.

James’s current strengths that can be capitalised on in actualising his learning potential are:

Strength of finding	Indications of existing skill	Description
3	Metacognitive awareness	James already effectively applies a number of metacognitive criteria to guide processing activities. Those who show a meta-awareness of their thinking tend to learn from their mistakes relatively quickly (see the theoretical model).
2	Right brain preference	He seems to prefer the world of ideas to that of tangible facts. He also showed more skill in making sense of ideas and integrating information than in the analysis of factual matters. Integrating information is more difficult than the analysis information – which is a foundation upon which James can further develop his analytical skills. If the person has a personality preference for ideas and integration, it may limit their motivation to learn more effective analytical skills.

Note: the strength of the finding is indicated numerically in the table above. Higher numbers indicate a more significant finding. Treat scores two and above as significant.

CPP summary report

This is a brief summary of James's information processing results. His recommended current and potential work environments, stylistic preferences as well as a number of additional observations and special insights into James's processing tendencies are provided.

Current work environment

James's cognitive profiles best matches the requirements of **Tactical Strategy** work environments. These contexts involve management and / or professional work. Within a business milieu it may entail planning, budgeting, project management and resource allocation. Operational systems are evaluated, improved and new systems are implemented to optimise operational efficiencies. Alternative tactical strategies are formulated to maximise the goal achievement of a functional unit in the organisation. The focus is on tangible systems and the time frame involved may be one to three years from decision making to when feedback becomes available.

Potential work environment

James's profile indicates that he may have the potential to work with the complexity requirements of the **Parallel Processing** environments. This means that he shows the necessary cognitive capability and skill to deal with complex, vague, interactive and dynamic systems within a five year time frame. Parallel processing work may involve the formulation of broad strategy; the integration of broad with operational strategy; the conceptualisation and modelling of business processes; the integration of value chains as well as internal and external factors; organisational transformation initiatives and the development of new functionalities – all of which are aimed at ensuring organisational viability. Executive roles involving the coordination of various functional units in the organisation as well as chief specialist roles may be involved

Stylistic preferences

The way a person approaches problems gives insight into how they think, what problems they are best suited to solve and the complexity they can work with. James applied an Explorative approach. This involves a tendency to investigate and gather information to excess sometimes, which can delay decision-making. This approach was mixed with a Quick insight style. This involves a tendency to grasp concepts relatively quickly. This can indicate that James values the speed at which he processes information. He also showed a tendency to use a Learning style. James may enjoy pursuing cognitive challenges, acquiring new skills and improving own functioning. Lastly, James can also process information using an Intuitive style. This involves a tendency to show openness, awareness and rely on "gut feel" insights.

Additional observations and special insights

- James's problem-solving performance appears to be within an average to high range.
- He obtained relatively equal scores for discriminating between relevant and irrelevant information in a structured and an unstructured environment. This is an indication that James should be able to adapt to working in both structured and unstructured contexts.
- He obtained relatively high scores on the identification of core aspects and on quick insight, compared to relatively low scores on a need for precision and the disciplined following through of arguments. This may indicate that James may not generally utilise his full cognitive potential.
- He obtained a relatively low score on verbal conceptualisation when compared to his average functioning. This may indicate that he needs to improve his formulation of abstract verbalisations and adopt a more creative approach in expressing ideas.
- A lower score on analytical skills compared to integrative skills usually indicates that James has the potential to acquire a more detailed, precise and systematic approach to problem-solving with relative ease.

Developmental guidelines

The following section is included for the benefit of the CPP accredited practitioner who will be providing feedback to the candidate. Statements in this section are based on an automated interpretation of the differences between this candidate's CPP processing scores. Not all comments necessarily apply, and it is up to the practitioner to select those guidelines that may be useful to the candidate in developing additional cognitive skills given the cognitive competency requirements of his particular work environment.

Notes: Interpreting the Development Guidelines

These competency indications are relative to your own overall functioning. In other words, if your scores are relatively low on analysis compared to the rest of your profile, it will be mentioned here - even if your analytical skills are better developed than most other people.

How we apply ourselves intellectually is largely determined by overall physical, psychological, emotional and spiritual awareness, our external context (exposure and opportunities) as well as the interaction amongst internal and external factors. The individual does, however, have a significant degree of choice when it comes to applying and developing themselves.

The extent of the finding is indicated in numbers in blue.

Low verbal conceptualisation 3

The manner in which ideas are formulated and verbally expressed, as well as the accompanying non-verbal messages, are very important interpersonal tools.

James seems to prefer visual and / or kinaesthetic modes to that of verbal and / or auditive modes of information processing. Alternatively he may tend to conceptualise issues in an uncomplicated, straightforward and factual manner. In certain cases, significantly lower scores on verbal conceptualisation may indicate emotional factors.

James may want to develop a somewhat more creative and interesting approach to the way in which concepts are formulated. The quality (namely the unusualness, coherence and abstraction) of conceptualisations, may improve communication, trigger interest and influence the perceptions of others. Analogies and metaphors can, for example, be used to sway the perceptions and opinions of others. Abstract language, storytelling and flowery expressions can also be useful, but only up to a point as these aspects may create confusion.

Less effective memory strategies 1

James did not effectively apply memory strategies. The most important factors in remembering information are: (a) meaningfulness, (b) interest in the subject material, (c) subjective emotional factors, (d) one's value system, and (e) the context.

By using certain techniques (anchoring, visualisation, associations, word bridges), most people can, with relative ease, achieve a significant improvement in their memory functioning. However, none of these techniques necessarily have long-term boosting effects on memory, unless the material is interesting and has emotional value for the person.

Cognitively, there are also techniques that can be practiced to simplify information and create links, associations and meaning. For example:

- *continuous integration (responding with both assimilation and accommodation of cognitive structures to new information)*
- *creating a rich network of associations*
- *frequent practice of knowledge or skills*
- *effective representation of information using maps, summaries, metaphors or pictures*
- *identifying the core element and extracting it as the basis for creating a new information structure*
- *attaching motivational / emotional value – such as using humour, or linking information to familiar people*

Possible underperformance 1

A number of factors may contribute to underperformance, the most important possibilities are: inadequate self-confidence and drive, low levels of self-insight and awareness, emotional and psychological factors, as well as environmental circumstances (such as educational and work opportunities and long-term exposure to unstimulating contexts). These issues often give rise to adaptational and motivational patterns that, over time, are internalised.

Exploring the possible reasons for underperformance and addressing them can result in a change of attitude and energy invested in work. It may benefit the person to become aware of their potential and the degree to which self-actualisation has occurred.

Transactional management: technical, management and professional work

This orientation is associated with transactional managers who deal with tangible issues within a functional unit of an organisation. They often have to solve problems by identifying causes and implementing solutions.

Their work therefore involves a combination of technical and theoretically-based operational and managerial issues. Although the contexts in which they work are relatively structured, many alternatives are available. The application of diagnostic and tactical approaches often involves the prevention of problems, optimising systems and supervision or management. The specific tasks entail:

- investigation via observation, measurement and monitoring
- analysis of the results in terms of a technical knowledge-base
- planning and structuring tangible issues
- the implementation and control of solutions / systems

Transactional managers may want to optimise operational outputs, implement systems, practical solutions and operational strategies. The most important skills to have within this orientation are logical-analytical skills and a learning orientation. Non-cognitive skills that aid effective functioning in this environment are self-confidence, a results orientation, interpersonal skills, effective communication, motivation and experience.

Parallel processing environments: transformational management

This orientation is required in the case of transformational managers who focus on organisational integration and long-term organisational viability. They are responsible for the alignment of processes across different operational systems, internal and external value-chains and the translation of the broad organisational strategy into operational goals.

The cognitive skills that are useful at this level of work are big picture thinking, an integrative and holistic approach, effective judgement, a learning orientation and logical rigour. An effective transformational approach also requires non-cognitive skills such as interest, energy, self-confidence, intra- and interpersonal understanding, leadership awareness and persuasion.

The cognitive capability to deal with complexity at Parallel processing level is however, not sufficient to ensure effective functioning at this level. Leadership skills, knowledge and experience are also critical prerequisites for performance in Parallel processing environments. In the case of inexperienced candidates that show this level of cognitive potential, a career path should ideally be considered to ensure varied and relevant experience.

High pragmatic orientation 1

This person seems particularly capable of discriminating between relevant and irrelevant information in factual, practical and structured environments. This is normally indicative of a definite pragmatic orientation which reflects metacognitive awareness of the issue of functionality, or "will this work in practice".

These individuals can therefore capitalize on clarity and focus in practical environments. They often have practical interests as well.

Lower scores on transformational thinking 1

James appears to have scored relatively lower scores on transformational thinking. Although this is linked to creativity, creativity was not directly measured. The assessment does measure the tendency to reconceptualise or rethink issues and think logically and laterally. Scores on transformational thinking are also indicative of motivation and energy as reconceptualising issues is hard work.

Low scores on both of the transformational subscales may indicate:

- Being tired
- Having a stagnant work position or routine job for a long period of time
- Being demotivated (work in general or specifically this assessment)
- Not particularly enjoying cognitive challenges (maybe because of other interests and values)
- Be generally quite accepting of information that is given to them, without really wanting to rethink it for themselves (especially in combination with high memory scores).
- Not be innovatively inclined (possibly because of personality profile)

This guideline needs to be interpreted by taking contextual factors, personality profiles, values, and the optimism of the person into consideration.

Low analytical orientation 1

Analytical skills include exploration, detail precision, rule orientation, structuring skills, memory and many others. The person's profile should be considered as a whole to determine what approach the person takes to problem-solving.

James received relatively low scores on analysis, defined here as detail and precision. This can have the following implications on the person's behaviour:

- Usually, the person may not independently initiate analytical activity. He may not pull issues apart, differentiate between subcomponents. Also, James may not focus on identifying relationships and link the elements together in a meaningful way. This can impact on the person's effectiveness in technical environments as they may become confused by detail, prone to making errors, superficial, bored and overwhelmed.

If a low score on analytical is combined with other scores, then some special insights may apply:

- If a low analytical score is combined with Trial-and-error or Reactive styles, then the person could be affected by feelings of insecurity or a need to escape from the test situation. The person may do the first thing that comes to mind, without strategising how they would solve the problem.
- If a low analytical score is combined with high scores on memory or a Memory style, then the person can work with detail, but probably likes to capitalise on knowledge and experience or other acquired skills. These people may only be unanalytical in unfamiliar environments.
- If a low analytical score is combined with an Explorative or Reflective style, it may indicate a very careful, uncertain approach. The person may become confused about the task requirements and explore – but not strategically or economically. In this data-finding approach, the person may be overwhelmed with information.
- If a low analytical score is combined with a low score on pragmatic and judgement (clarification in structured and unstructured environments respectively). This profile is a strong indication that the person needs guidelines to work effectively. This profile is common in individuals from disadvantaged backgrounds or people who are preoccupied. The memory, complexity and learning scores are an indication of the person's future capability.
- If a low analytical score is combined with a low score on judgement but not pragmatic then the person may be fearful, have low confidence in their own capability and may want some guidelines. They tend to go about their work independently and analytically – in their own way. However, they usually do not want to be faced with decision-making in vague environments.
- If a low analytical score is combined with higher scores on transformational thinking (logical reasoning and verbal abstraction) especially when the person's complexity score exceeds 60, then the person probably shows a right-brain orientation. They may get bored with technical detail – especially if a person's quick insight learning is greater than their gradual improvement learning.

A low analytical orientation should be interpreted in terms of contextual work requirements, the available team members, educational qualifications and options and personality preferences.

Final comments

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The CPP is a complex instrument and it requires comprehensive training to interpret the report. Feedback on this report should always be done by an accredited CPP practitioner.

We hope to have provided you with the insight needed to make informed decisions and unlock potential. If you would like a more detailed description of the concepts dealt with in this report, a full guide and glossary is available at:
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